

UI / UX Documentation

Research to Design System

Research

Personas

IA

Wireframes

Design System



PERSONAS

Manager + Team

LANGUAGES

EN / ES / FR / DE

SCREENS

5 core flows

1. Research

1.1 Problem Space

Project managers in small-to-medium teams spend a disproportionate amount of time on **setup work** rather than actual supervision: breaking a project brief into tasks, deciding what roles are needed, screening who has the right skills, and then chasing people for status updates. Existing tools (Jira, Asana, Monday) assume this breakdown work has already been done by a human.

1.2 Research Questions

- Where does the most time go when starting a new project?
- How do managers currently decide who to staff on which role?
- What causes status information to go stale?
- Why do team members avoid updating task boards?
- What communication happens outside the project tool, and why?

1.3 Key Findings

#	Finding	Design Implication
F1	Project setup (writing tasks, defining roles) consumes the first 2-3 days of any new project	Automate task and role generation from a brief or PDF — AI does the first draft, human edits
F2	Managers pick team members from memory or gut feel, not systematic skill comparison	Score and rank candidates by measurable skill overlap so the shortlist is defensible
F3	Team members skip status updates because switching context to a board feels like overhead	Let status updates happen inside a conversation — the tool people are already in
F4	Status is stale because updating requires finding the right task in a nested UI	Expand tasks inline, one click to change status, no modal or separate page
F5	Real coordination happens in Slack/WhatsApp, disconnected from the project data	Put team chat next to the tasks so context and conversation share a screen
F6	Notification fatigue causes people to mute project tools entirely	Make alerts opt-in per user, and keep only unavoidable ones (meetings) mandatory

1.4 Competitive Scan

Tool	Strength	Gap this project addresses
Jira	Deep workflow customization, mature integrations	No AI task generation; heavy setup cost; steep learning curve
Asana	Clean UI, good task hierarchy	Manual task creation; no staffing/hiring layer
Monday.com	Highly visual, flexible boards	No candidate matching; chat is bolt-on, not contextual
Notion	Flexible docs + databases	Not purpose-built for supervision; no role-based permissions per task

2. Personas

Two primary personas drove every access-control and layout decision in the product.

Elena — The Supervising Manager

Primary persona • Manager role

"I do not want to write fifty tickets before the work can even start."

Goals

- ✓ Stand up a new project in under an hour, not three days
- ✓ See at a glance which roles are still unstaffed
- ✓ Know today which tasks are slipping, without asking anyone
- ✓ Hire the right person for a role based on evidence, not memory

Frustrations

- ✗ Writing task breakdowns by hand for every new project
- ✗ Chasing people in three different apps for a status
- ✗ Discovering a task was blocked two weeks after it happened

Marcus — The Hired Specialist

Secondary persona • Team Member role

"Just show me my work. I do not need to see the whole company."

Goals

- ✓ See only the projects and tasks that concern him
- ✓ Update progress in two clicks without leaving what he is doing
- ✓ Ask a question and get an answer without scheduling a meeting
- ✓ Not be responsible for parts of the project outside his role

Frustrations

- ✗ Dashboards full of information that is not his job
- ✗ Being able to accidentally change someone else's task
- ✗ Tools that email him about everything until he mutes them

2.1 Persona-Driven Decisions

Persona need	Product decision	Where it shows up
Elena: fast project setup	AI generates tasks + roles from a PDF or description	AddProject page, two-step AI pipeline
Elena: evidence-based hiring	Candidates ranked by skill-match percentage	Candidates page, CandidateCard match badge
Elena: know what is slipping	Delayed status as a first-class state, surfaced on the dashboard	Overdue Tasks stat card, red StatusBadge
Marcus: only my work	Team members see only projects they are hired into	Dashboard project list filtered by project_members

Marcus: cannot break things	Task edits gated by hired role_id	TaskItem canEditFields, API role check
Marcus: low-friction updates	Four status buttons inline in the expanded task	TaskItem progress grid
Both: less noise	Alerts opt-in per user; meetings always send	Settings → Notifications toggles

3. Information Architecture

3.1 Navigation Model

A persistent left sidebar holds all top-level destinations. Sidebar items are filtered by role, so a team member never sees a door they cannot open.

Destination	Path	Manager	Team Member
Dashboard	/dashboard	Visible	Visible
Add / Edit Project	/addproject	Visible	Hidden + route guarded
Candidates	/candidates	Visible	Hidden + route guarded
Settings	/settings/profile	Visible	Visible
Log Out	→ /login	Visible	Visible
Project View	/projects/:id	Visible	Visible (own projects only)

3.2 Site Map

```
Login / Register / OAuth Callback / Complete Profile
|
+-- Dashboard (stats, project list, roles chart, calendar, floating chat)
|   +-- Project View /projects/:id (tasks + docked chat)
|
+-- Add / Edit Project [Manager only]
|   +-- Create flow: details → PDF upload → AI review → save
|   +-- Update flow: select project → upload → AI merge → save
|
+-- Candidates [Manager only]
|   +-- Select project → select role → ranked candidates → hire
|
+-- Settings
    +-- Profile | Notifications | Appearance
```

3.3 Content Hierarchy per Screen

Screen	Primary	Secondary	Tertiary
Dashboard	Stats cards (state of the world)	Project list + completion chart	Calendar, floating chat
Project View	Task list with inline expansion	Progress bar and overall status	Docked chat panel
Candidates	Ranked candidate cards	Role cards with staffing counts	Project selector
Add Project	Name + description inputs	PDF dropzone	Generated task/role editors
Settings	Active sub-page form	Settings menu	Save state feedback

4. Key User Flows

4.1 Manager: Zero to Staffed Project

Step	Screen	Action	System Response
1	Add Project	Enter name + description	Project row created
2	Add Project	Drop PDF spec (optional)	Text extracted via unpdf
3	Add Project	Click Upload Project	AI generates roles, then tasks assigned to those roles
4	Add Project	Review and edit generated content	Inline editors for tasks and roles
5	Add Project	Click Save Project	Tasks and roles written to DB
6	Candidates	Auto-redirect, select a role	AI backfills any missing role_id, candidates scored and ranked
7	Candidates	Select candidates and click Hire	project_members rows created; hiring emails sent

4.2 Team Member: Report Progress

Step	Action	Design rationale
1	Open Dashboard, see only hired projects	Reduces cognitive load; no irrelevant data
2	Click arrow to open project	One click from overview to detail
3	Click a task to expand inline	No modal, no navigation, context preserved
4	Click one of four status buttons	Status change is a single tap, not a dropdown
5 (alt)	Type "I finished X" in AI chat	Conversational path for people who avoid boards

4.3 Flow Principles Applied

Principle	Application
Progressive disclosure	Task details, edit fields, and assignment controls only appear once a task is expanded
Recognition over recall	Roles show hired/total counts; candidates show match % — no need to remember who has what skill
Two paths to the same outcome	Status can be changed by clicking a button OR by describing it to the AI
Fail visibly, recover cheaply	Delayed is a normal status, not an error state — it is one click and reversible
Defaults that respect attention	Both notification toggles default to OFF; the floating chat starts minimized

5. Wireframes

Low-fidelity layout structure for the three highest-traffic screens.

5.1 Dashboard

Sidebar (fixed 240px) Stats Cards x5 (x4 for team members)
Project List (scrollable, click to select, arrow to open) Roles Breakdown Donut + Completion %
Deadline Calendar — month grid, dots for meetings / deadlines, click date opens day panel
Floating Chat bubble — bottom right, minimized by default

5.2 Project View

Project title
Project card header: name, description, overall status badge, progress bar
Task rows (collapsed) — chevron, title, role tag, status badge Chat panel (docked, full height)
Expanded task: What (editable) / How (editable) / Skills / 4 status buttons / Assign to role members AI Messages tabs
Task rows continue... message input

5.3 Candidates

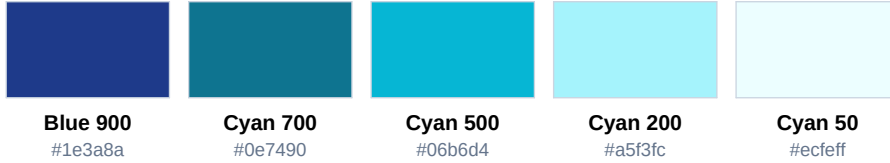
Project selector dropdown

Role cards column (title, hired/total, click to select) | Candidate cards grid (avatar, match %, headline, skills, Select/Hired)

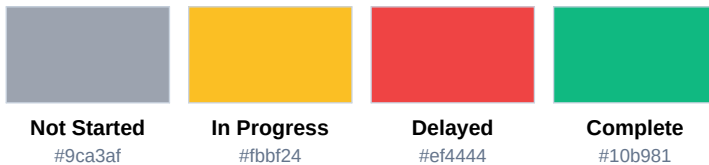
6. Design System

6.1 Color Palette

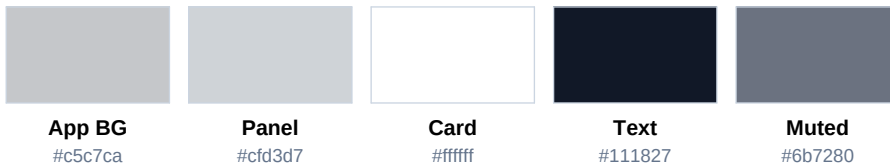
Brand gradient



Status colors



Surface & text



6.2 Color Usage Rules

Element	Treatment	Rationale
Primary action / sent message	Gradient blue-900 → cyan-500, white text	Single strong brand signal reserved for user-initiated actions
Received message / neutral surface	Gray 100 background, gray 800 text	Keeps the conversation visually asymmetric and scannable
Active nav item	Same brand gradient	Location in the app is always unambiguous
Delayed status	Red 500	Only place red is used, so it never competes for attention
Complete status	Green 500	Reserved exclusively for finished work
Destructive icon	Red 400, revealed on hover only	Present but not inviting

6.3 Typography Scale

Token	Size	Weight	Usage
Page title	30px / text-3xl	Bold	Project name, dashboard heading
Section title	20px / text-xl	Semibold	Settings sections, card headers
Card title	18px / text-lg	Bold	Project card name
Body	14px / text-sm	Regular	Task descriptions, form labels
Small	12px / text-xs	Regular	Chat messages, metadata, buttons

Micro	10px	Bold + uppercase + tracking	Field labels (WHAT, HOW, PROGRESS)
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6.4 Spacing & Shape

Token	Value	Applied to
Card radius	rounded-2xl (16px)	Project cards, chat panel, stat cards
Control radius	rounded-xl (12px)	Buttons, inputs, status pills
Badge radius	rounded-full	Status badges, skill chips, avatars
Panel padding	p-6 (24px)	Card interiors
Stack gap	gap-4 (16px)	Grid and flex layouts
Tight gap	gap-2 (8px)	Icon + label pairs, chat rows
Sidebar width	240px fixed	Constant across all screens
Chat panel width	320px fixed	Docked in project view, floating on dashboard

6.5 Component Library

Component	States	Behavior notes
StatusBadge	not_started, in_progress, delayed, complete, active, archived	Color-coded pill; single source of truth for status color
TaskItem	collapsed, expanded, editing	Chevron rotates 90deg on expand; edit pencil appears on hover
ProjectCard	with tasks, empty	Gradient progress bar; footer shows completed/total counts
CandidateCard	available, selected, hired	Match % badge color shifts green/amber/red by score
StatsCards	manager (5 cards), team (4 cards)	Overdue card turns red with warning text when count > 0
ProjectChat	AI tab, Messages inbox, conversation	Back arrow returns to inbox; 3s polling in conversations
FloatingChat	minimized bubble, expanded panel	Wraps ProjectChat — one implementation, two entry points
DeadlineCalendar	month grid, day panel, create form	Events listed before the create form on day click
Toggle	on, off, saving	Saves immediately on change, no explicit save button
Sidebar	per-role item set	Manager-only items removed from DOM, not just hidden

6.6 Interaction Patterns

Pattern	Rule
Destructive actions	Icon-only, revealed on hover, red on hover — discoverable but never accidental
Saving feedback	Inline text ("Saving...") rather than toasts or modals
Empty states	Always paired with the action that resolves them ("No conversations yet." + "Start one")
Loading	Skeleton text with pulse animation; chat uses three bouncing dots
Scrollbars	Hidden globally while preserving scroll behavior
Preference changes	Applied instantly and persisted — no Save button in Appearance or Notifications

7. Accessibility & Localization

7.1 Accessibility Considerations

Area	Approach
Color independence	Status is communicated by label text and a colored dot, never color alone
Contrast	White text only on blue-900/cyan-700 end of the gradient; body text at gray-800 on light surfaces
Target size	Status buttons and nav items use generous padding (py-2 to py-3) for comfortable tap targets
Keyboard	Enter sends chat messages; native focus rings retained on inputs and buttons
Semantics	Buttons for actions, NavLink for navigation — never a div with an onClick for primary actions
Motion	Transitions limited to 200-500ms opacity and transform; no parallax or autoplay

7.2 Localization Model

Four languages ship in the bundle: **English, Spanish, French, German**. All strings live in a single `i18n.js` resource file grouped by feature section. Language changes apply instantly via `i18n.changeLanguage()` and persist to the user profile, so the choice follows the user across devices. Date format is a separate preference (MM/DD/YYYY, DD/MM/YYYY, YYYY-MM-DD) with a live preview in Settings.

Localization concern	Design response
Text expansion in DE/FR	Flexible widths, whitespace-nowrap only on short nav labels, truncation with title attributes on long names
Instant switching	<code>key={i18n.language}</code> on page roots forces a clean remount so every string refreshes
Persistence	<code>preferred_language</code> saved via <code>PUT /users/preferences</code> and reloaded on login
Date display	<code>formatDate()</code> helper reads <code>preferred_date_format</code> from context, applied consistently

8. Design Decisions Log

Decision	Considered	Chosen because
Inline task expansion	Modal drawer vs inline expand	Modal broke context and required an extra dismiss action; inline keeps the list visible
Four status buttons	Dropdown vs segmented buttons	Buttons make all states visible at once and reduce the update to a single tap
Chat docked beside tasks	Separate chat page vs docked panel	Coordination and the work it refers to belong on the same screen
Floating chat on dashboard	Full panel vs minimized bubble	Bubble keeps the dashboard uncluttered while chat stays one click away
Match % over binary fit	Pass/fail filter vs percentage	A ranked list preserves manager judgement instead of hiding near-misses
Notifications default OFF	Opt-out vs opt-in	Opt-in respects attention and avoids the mute-everything failure mode

Delayed as a status	Overdue computed from dates vs explicit status	An explicit status is honest and human-controlled, not inferred from a missed date
Role-filtered assignment	All members vs role members only	Prevents assigning a designer to a database task by mistake